Google Civic Information API: Capabilities & App Ideas

As of October 27, 2026

Overview

The Civic Information API now covers elections and political divisions only. The Representatives endpoint (look up elected officials by address) was shut down in April 2025. Google replaced it with a `divisionByAddress` endpoint that returns Open Civic Data IDs (OCD-IDs) for an address, which you can use to look up officials in third-party datasets. Many older tutorials still show the removed endpoint, so ignore those.

What the API can do now

Base URL: `https://www.googleapis.com/civicinfo/v2`. You need only an API key, no OAuth.

Method	Endpoint	What it returns
electionQuery	`GET /elections`	List of available elections: ID, name, date, OCD division ID. Test election ID `2000` is always available for development.
voterInfoQuery	`GET /voterinfo?address=...`	Voter info for a registered address (details below). If no election ID is given and several elections match, extras appear in `otherElections`.
divisions.search	`GET /divisions`	Political divisions searched by natural name or OCD ID.
divisionByAddress	`GET /divisionsByAddress`	All districts for an address (congressional, state legislative, county, etc.) as OCD-IDs.

Data you can get from `/voterinfo`, depending on the election and state:

- Polling places: address, hours, notes
- Early voting sites and ballot drop-off locations
- Contests on the ballot: offices, candidates (name, party, website, social links), referendums and ballot measures with their text
- Election officials: state and local election office contacts, plus links for registration, absentee ballots and ballot info
- Whether the election is mail-only, plus precinct info

Important limitations

- **Data is seasonal.** Voter info is populated only in the weeks before an election; outside election season `/voterinfo` often returns little or nothing.
- **US only**, and coverage varies by state and county.

- **No representatives data.** For "who represents me," use another source: Census geocoder for districts, the open congressional-legislators dataset for federal officials, and OpenStates (free key) for state legislators. The open-source who_reps-mcp project combines these.

App ideas

Start with #1 or #2: they use `/voterinfo` directly and are easy to demo with test election `2000`.

#	App	What it does	Endpoints
1	"Where do I vote?" finder	Address in; polling place, early-vote sites and drop boxes on a map with directions (pair with Google Maps API)	`/voterinfo`
2	Personal sample ballot	Every contest and ballot measure for an address; users read candidate links and mark picks to print or save	`/voterinfo`
3	Election reminder app	Saves the user's address, pulls upcoming elections, sends email/SMS reminders for early voting and Election Day	`/elections`, `/voterinfo`
4	"Know your districts" page	Address to every district the user belongs to, optionally linked to OpenStates/Census data for officials	`divisionByAddress`
5	Ballot measure explainer	Pulls referendum text and uses an LLM for plain-language or translated summaries for non-native English voters	`/voterinfo`
6	Polling access analysis	Collects polling and early-vote site data across counties; analyzes voters per site or distance to nearest site	`/voterinfo`, `/divisions`

Documentation and sources

- API reference — developers.google.com/civic-information/docs/v2
- Getting started / API key — developers.google.com/civic-information/docs/using_api
- Announcement group (shutdowns and updates)
- divisionByAddress launch announcement
- Representatives API turndown notice
- who_reps-mcp (open replacement)